# 🎨 Renaissance: Reading

World History · Unit 3 · Level 2 (modified) · our own reading

Name: _____

*Words to know:* ***patron*** *= a rich supporter who pays an artist ·* ***sculptor*** *= an artist who carves statues*



Leonardo da Vinci, self-portrait (red chalk)



Michelangelo: Sistine Chapel ceiling

## Leonardo and Michelangelo

Leonardo da Vinci was born in 1452 near Florence, Italy. As a teenager he learned to paint in the workshop of the artist Verrocchio. He was curious about everything: plants, water, birds and the human body.

Leonardo painted **The Last Supper** on a wall in Milan and the **Mona Lisa**, a portrait of Lisa del Giocondo. He blended colors softly, with no hard lines. This is called **sfumato**.

Leonardo kept notebooks with thousands of pages. He sketched ideas for flying machines, a tank and weapons. He also studied **anatomy**, the parts of the body. He wrote backwards, in mirror writing.

Michelangelo Buonarroti was born in 1475. As a boy he studied art in Florence and lived in the home of the rich **Medici** family, who were **patrons** (supporters) of artists.

Michelangelo called himself a **sculptor**, not a painter. He carved the **Pietà** and the giant statue **David** from marble. Pope Julius II hired him to paint the **Sistine Chapel** ceiling. They argued about it, but he finished in 1512.

Both artists were influenced by the Catholic Church and by Greek and Roman ideas. Both were skilled in many subjects, so each is called a **Renaissance man**.

## Check your reading

**1. What is sfumato?**

A. painting on wet plaster

B. carving marble

C. soft, smoky blending of colors

**2. Michelangelo saw himself mainly as a…**

A. sculptor | B. inventor | C. banker

**3. Who hired Michelangelo to paint the Sistine Chapel ceiling?**

A. the King of France | B. Leonardo | C. Pope Julius II

4. Why is each man called a “Renaissance man”?